Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
General Administrative				
24.100	Subject Files (obsolete)	These records are used to support administrative analysis, program and project planning, procedure development, and programmatic activities. Subject files are generally organized alphabetically by topic. Document types may include periodic activity reports (narrative and statistical), special reports, topical correspondence (including electronic mail), research materials, project planning notes, organizational charts, etc. Subject files do NOT include files related to individual program activities, human resources files, and accounting records. For topics of continuing interest, files may be segmented into annual files. Some topical files may have historical value and should be preserved permanently.	Superseded by GS #35.100	3/31/2026
24.101	General Correspondence (obsolete)	General correspondence does not pertain to a specific issue and it is often organized chronologically or by correspondent's name. General correspondence may include referral correspondence. If the correspondence does pertain to a specific issue it should be filed with other relevant records. General correspondence may exist in a variety of formats, including memos, letters, notes and electronic mail messages. This series also includes automated or manual tools that index and/or track when correspondence was received, the topic of the correspondence, who is responsible for responding to the correspondence, and when the correspondence is considered closed for further action.	Superseded by GS #35.102	3/31/2026
24.102	Transitory Correspondence (obsolete)	Transitory correspondence is any form of written communication with a short-term interest that has no documentary value. This type of correspondence has limited administrative and evidential value that is lost soon after the communication is received. Transitory messages do not set policy, establish guidelines or procedures, certify a transaction or become a receipt. Examples of transitory correspondence include letters of transmittal that do not add information to the transmitted materials, routine requests for information that require no administrative action, policy decision, special compilation or research. This type of record also includes invitations to work-related events, notifications of an upcoming meeting, and similar records.	Superseded by GS #35.125	3/31/2026

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Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.103	Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) Requests (obsolete)	This file will document any requests for information or public records. They may include requests for information, correspondence, a copy of the information released, and billing information. Any written request for a public record is a Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request, and a written request for information may be a FOIA request and should be handled as one. Each city or village is required by the FOIA to designate a FOIA Coordinator. This is not automatically the clerk, but it may be the clerk or another official or employee. Copies of FOIA requests and other records related to FOIA requests may be filed with the FOIA Coordinator's records or maintained in a central administrative file.	Superseded by GS #35.107	3/31/2026
24.104	Planners and Calendars (obsolete)	These may be electronic or manual planners and calendars that are used to track an individual staff member’s work-related meetings, assignments, and tasks. Individual employees are responsible for retaining their planners/calendars for the duration of this retention period.	Superseded by GS #35.101	3/31/2026
24.105	Staff and Project Meeting Records (obsolete)	These records document staff meetings, meetings with other government agencies, etc. These records do not include council meetings and other official boards, committees or commissions. They may include meeting minutes, agendas, and distribution materials, etc. Meeting records may also be retained in subject files, if they relate to a specific project.	Superseded by GS #35.113	3/31/2026
24.106	Grants (obsolete)	These files are used to administer grants that are applied for by the office from state, federal and private agencies. These files may contain applications, budgets, worksheets, adjustments, plans, rules and regulations, award letters, committee records, staffing sheets with account numbers, grant evaluation and monitoring reports, audits, periodic progress reports, etc.	Superseded by GS #35.109	3/31/2026
24.107	Publications (obsolete)	These records may include press releases, brochures, newsletters, annual reports and other items that are published by the office. Offices are strongly encouraged to keep one copy permanently for historical purposes.	Superseded by GS #35.120	3/31/2026
24.108	Policies, Procedures and Directives (obsolete)	These records document the policies procedures of the clerk's office. It may also include an administrative manual of all city and village functions.	Superseded by GS #35.118	3/31/2026
24.109	Clerk's Office Budget (obsolete)	These records document the amount of money that is appropriated for each account and line item for the current and previous fiscal years for the clerk’s office. They may include budget requests, statistics, budget amendments, budget summaries and balance sheets, etc. This is not the official city or village budget.	Superseded by GS #35.104	3/31/2026

Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.110	Memorabilia (obsolete)	This series includes photographs, news clippings, certificates, awards, etc. that document events and activities of the office. Offices are strongly encouraged to retain select items permanently for historical purposes.	Superseded by GS #35.122	3/31/2026
Council and Commission				
24.200	Meeting Records - Open Sessions (obsolete)	These records document the proceedings of the city or village council or commission and any subcommittees or advisory committees. They include the approved minutes and agenda packets containing any materials that are distributed to members for review (such as budgets, ordinances, resolutions, action items, policies, contracts, etc.). They may include full transcriptions of the proceedings, and topical indexes. This series does not include meeting notices (see item #203), bulletins, clippings, citizen requests (see item #204) or documentation of meeting- related expenditures. These records are preserved permanently to document the institutional memory of the city or village. Cities and villages are encouraged to contact the Archives of Michigan for assistance if they cannot retain these records permanently.	Superseded by GS #35.116	3/31/2026
24.201	Meeting Notes and Audio or Video Recordings (obsolete)	Notes and audio or visual recordings of meetings of a public body of the city or village made for the purpose of transcribing the minutes may be destroyed after the meeting at which the minutes are approved by the public body.	Superseded by GS #35.112	3/31/2026
24.202	Meeting Records - Closed Sessions (obsolete)	These records consist of minutes taken during a closed session of the council or commission, including any audio or visual recordings. Approved closed session minutes must be sealed and retained by the clerk, are not available to the public, and shall only be disclosed if required by a civil action filed in circuit court or the court of appeals under sections 10, 11, or 13 of the Open Meetings Act.	Superseded by GS #35.115	3/31/2026

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Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.203	Meeting Records - Official Boards, Committees and Commissions (obsolete)	These records document the proceedings of the official boards, committees and commissions (such as an historical commission, arts commission, development authority, board of review, civil service board, etc.). Members of these boards are appointed by the city or village council or commission. These records include the approved minutes and agenda packets containing any materials that are distributed to members for review and action. In some cities and villages, each of these bodies are responsible for providing the clerk with the official copy of the approved minutes and agenda packets. In some cities and villages, these records are maintained separately by the public body. Regardless, of where they are maintained, this retention period applies.	Superseded by GS #31.137	3/31/2026
24.204	Notices of a Public Meeting (obsolete)	The Open Meetings Act requires public bodies to publish a notice to the public prior to holding a meeting or a hearing.	Superseded by GS #35.114	3/31/2026
24.205	Citizen Requests	These requests are received from citizens who want to be heard by the city or village council or commission. They may relate to events, street closings, contract protests, complaints, requests for hearings, investigations, rallies, etc. These records may be in the form of correspondence or application forms. Depending upon the issue, they may need to be reviewed by another city or village department (in which case a report may be generated and retained as part of the record series). Some requests may need to be approved by the council (with or without conditions).	RETAIN UNTIL: Date created PLUS: 1 year THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.206	Member Files (obsolete)	These files contain information about people who served on the council or commission and appointees to other official boards, committees and commissions. They may contain applications, biographical information, petitions, conference and training requests, correspondence, etc.	Superseded by GS #35.119	3/31/2026
24.207	Board Member Applications	These records are applications from residents who are interested in serving on a city or village board, committee, commission, etc. If they are appointed, this record will become part of the member file (see item #206).	RETAIN UNTIL: Date created PLUS: 2 years THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.208	Rosters	These records list who served on a particular board, committee, commission, etc., and the dates of their term as a member of the public body.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.209	Oaths of Office	Certain public officials are required to sign an oath of office.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026

Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.210	Charter	The charter provides the legal framework for operations of the city or village's government. It defines boundaries, how the city or village operates on a daily basis, the responsibilities and authority of various public officials, and regulations that are adopted by the council or commission. The document is revised over time, however superseded versions will be retained permanently as an historical record.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.211	Ordinances	Codified ordinances document all laws enacted by the council or commission. They may include the text of the ordinance, public notices and vote sheets. A copy of these records may be compiled into a published codebook and database.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.212	Resolutions	These resolutions are adopted by the council or commission. They include the language of the resolution and any supporting documents for the resolution.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.213	Budget	The budget is approved by the council or commission. It documents revenues and expenditures, and allocations for each department. This record contains the final version, and any supplemental versions, revisions or amendments that are approved for each fiscal year.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.214	Annual Reports	Departments may submit annual reports to the chief elected official's office where they are compiled into a single annual report of the city or village's activities. The official copy of the departmental reports, as well as the compiled report, are maintained by the clerk.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.215	Published Public Notices	These records serve as evidence that the city or village provided public notice of elections, hearings, ordinance enactments or revisions, police auctions, bids, etc. in local news media. They may include Affidavits of Publication, clippings, and copies of the printer's bill or invoice. The city or village's finance or accounting office is the official recordkeeper for the billing records. These records may be retained with the other records that pertain to the event listed in the public notice. These records inherit the retention period of other record series, depending upon the type of event that is listed in the public notice.	RETAIN UNTIL: Event's record series retention period is met THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
Licensing and Permits				

Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.300	License and/or Permit Applications	These files contain applications for licenses and/or permits for various operations within city or village limits, as prescribed by ordinances, such as building, zoning, carnivals, solicitors, garage sales, pets, restaurants, taxis, etc. These records contain applicant information, information about the purpose of the license or permit, and it may contain supplemental documentation, such as blueprints, certificates of liability insurance, surety bonds, indemnity bonds, treasurer's reports, etc. The clerk may maintain a log, index, checklist or other document to keep track of licensees and the payment of fees.	RETAIN UNTIL: License or permit expires or is revoked PLUS: 1 year THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.301	Liquor License Applications	These files contain applications for licenses to sell alcoholic beverages. They records include applications to transfer a license to a new owner and to transfer a license to a new location. These records may include the application, inspections, police reports, payment documentation, local board, commission review, and approval documents, etc. The Michigan Liquor Control Commission maintains a duplicate copy of this record. These files include rejected applications.	RETAIN UNTIL: Business no longer owns the license (including escrow period) PLUS: 10 years THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.303	Incomplete License Applications	Individuals or businesses may fail to submit complete paperwork to receive a license from the city or village.	RETAIN UNTIL: Date created PLUS: 1 year THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.304	Non-Profit Recognition	The city or village may recognize non-profit organizations that wish to use city or village facilities for purposes that may include fundraising. The recognition of the organization does not expire. These files may include correspondence, 501c3 documentation, by-laws and articles of incorporation.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
Land and Property				
24.400	Cemetery Records	Cities and villages may own one or more cemeteries. These records document purchasers and occupiers of lots and burials. They may include maps, indexes, burial transit permits, certificates of title for burial rights, purchaser information, deeds for lots, deceased individual information, perpetual care and grounds records, interment and disinterment orders, etc. Cities and villages are encouraged to contact the Archives of Michigan for assistance if they cannot retain these records permanently.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026

Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.401	Property Records	These records document the ownership of city or village property. They include rights of way, easements, deeds, restrictive covenants, vacated properties, warranty deeds, quit claim deeds, annexations, interlocal agreements, incorporations, etc. Supporting documents may include land surveys, maps and drawings, plans, correspondence, legal property descriptions, agreements, resolutions, bond documentation, title insurance, etc. The county register of deeds will maintain copies of some of these records.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.402	Tax Credits	Property owners may be eligible for various tax credits (such as farmland preservation, enterprise zone, etc.). These credits are approved by the Michigan Department of Treasury, but they are also reviewed by various township departments and public bodies. These files may include applications, legal property descriptions, etc.	RETAIN UNTIL: Property owner no longer receives the tax credit PLUS: 7 years THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
Financial and Legal				
24.500	Insurance Policies (obsolete)	These files include insurance policies that provide coverage for property and casualty, workers compensation, errors and omission, general liability, umbrella, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.100	3/31/2026
24.501	Insurance Claims (obsolete)	These files are used to document claims that are submitted to an insurance provider. They may contain claim forms, correspondence and supporting documents for each claim that is submitted.	Superseded by GS #31.101	3/31/2026
24.502A	Accident Reports and Claims - Adults (obsolete)	Accident reports for personal injuries, property damage claims, and other incidents provide details about any unexpected incidents on city or village property. The reports may list the location of the accident, description of the accident, first aid administration, witnesses, person injured, type of injury or property damage, actions taken, recommendations to prevent reoccurrence, etc. The reports may be reviewed and signed by relevant administrators. These files may include related information, such as witness statements, medical information, legal counsel, subsequent claims, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.102A	3/31/2026

Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.502B	Accident Reports and Claims - Minors (obsolete)	Accident reports for personal injuries, property damage claims, and other incidents provide details about any unexpected incidents on city or village property. The reports may list the location of the accident, description of the accident, first aid administration, witnesses, person injured, type of injury or property damage, actions taken, recommendations to prevent reoccurrence, etc. The reports may be reviewed and signed by relevant administrators. These files may include related information, such as witness statements, medical information, legal counsel, subsequent claims, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.102B	3/31/2026
24.503	Bids and Quotes (obsolete)	Bids are received from vendors for services and contracts that the city or village needs for construction, furnishings, grounds maintenance, trash and snow removal, cleaning services, etc. These files may include the Invitation to Bid, the bid documents that are submitted, the reviewer documentation, etc. This record series included awarded and non-awarded bid proposals.	Superseded by GS #31.103A and #31.103B	3/31/2026
24.504	Contracts (obsolete)	These contracts may cover a variety of services including construction, custodial work, copiers, facility rental, Internet providers, maintenance, wiring, telephone services, employment, land, etc. These files may include contracts, correspondence with the vendor, warranties, copies of purchase orders, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.104	3/31/2026
24.505	Litigation (obsolete)	These files document any litigation to which the city or village is a party. The legal or general counsel will maintain the official and complete set of these documents. If the legal counsel is contracted by the city or village, the city or village may agree to be the official record keeper. These files may include depositions, transcripts, decisions, correspondence, data, exhibits, research materials, reports, press releases, media clippings, etc.	Superseded by GS #35.111	3/31/2026
24.506	Legal Opinions	These records document legal opinions issued by the city or village’s legal counsel.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026

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Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.507	Vital Records	Any city that is an active local registrar for vital records (births and deaths), and has been approved by the Department of Health and Human Services for that purpose is obligated to receive, file and retain vital records for that purpose. (MCL 333.2814-333.2815). If an active local registrar cannot retain these records permanently, they are encouraged to transfer records to the Archives of Michigan by order of the State Vital Records Registrar. All other cities and villages shall transfer their vital records to the Archives of Michigan by order of the State Vital Records Registrar.	PERMANENT	3/31/2026
24.508	Vehicle Files	These files document all vehicles owned by the city or village. They may include the registration, title, repair orders, documentation of all maintenance work that is performed, inspections, etc.	RETAIN UNTIL: Vehicle or equipment is no longer owned by the township THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.509	Accounting Transaction Detail (obsolete)	This information details all revenue, expenditures and balance sheets that are recorded in various accounts maintained by the city or village. It may be retained as paper, electronic data, computer output microfiche, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.107	3/31/2026
24.510	Chart of Accounts (obsolete)	This chart defines the accounting codes that are used in the accounting transaction detail (see item #509).	Superseded by GS #31.107	3/31/2026
24.511	Receivables (obsolete)	These records contain invoices that are sent to citizens, groups or companies that are billed for services, such as facility use, event and activity fees, utilities, permits, licenses, etc. They may include support documents, agreements, and ledgers.	Superseded by GS #31.108	3/31/2026
24.512	Receipts (obsolete)	These records document deposits into various accounts. They may include a cash receipt list, receipt register, etc. Information in these records may include the check number, date, receipt number, description, amount deposited, batch number, account number, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.109	3/31/2026
24.513	Journal Entries (obsolete)	These records document transfers between accounts, they record expenses not included in accounts payable, and revenues not in cash receipts. The transaction balance report may identify the account number, account description, transaction amount, date, journal entry number, transaction description, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.110	3/31/2026
24.514	Budget Summaries and Balance Sheets (obsolete)	These records document the status of budgetary activity on each account. They may identify the account balances per month and year to date, activity within the month on each account, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.111	3/31/2026

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Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.515	Payment Records (obsolete)	These files document the payment for goods and services. They may include purchase orders, packing slips, vouchers, requisitions, invoices, travel expenses, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.112	3/31/2026
24.516	Telephone and Communications Bills (obsolete)	These bills are received from the telephone service provider and may be used to generate bills that are distributed to each department. These bills may cover services for telephones, cellular phones, pagers, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.113	3/31/2026
24.517	Bank Activity (obsolete)	These records document activity on the city or village's bank account. They may include deposit slips, reconciliations, cancelled checks, bank statements, electronic funds transfer transactions, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.115	3/31/2026
24.518	Investments	These files include statements from investment accounts that identify the date and amount of each transaction, the maturity and balance of the account. They may include cash flow and reconcile statements that summarize the beginning and ending balance of the account and all transactions dates and amounts.	RETAIN UNTIL: Fiscal year ends PLUS: 1 year THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.519	Bonds (obsolete)	These records detail the terms of bond funding that was secured for construction and improvement projects. They include the final transcript of closing documents.	Superseded by GS #31.119	3/31/2026
24.520	Final Affidavit of Payment (obsolete)	The final affidavit of payment is evidence that all funds that were borrowed were paid back in full.	Superseded by GS #31.121	3/31/2026
24.521	Bond Cremation Certificates (obsolete)	The Bond Cremation Act (PA 56 of 1962) requires public corporations to cremate or disintegrate obligations or interest coupons upon maturity, and to receive a certificate documenting the destruction of the records.	Superseded by GS #31.122	3/31/2026
24.522	Supply Inventories	These records document the volume of supplies (office, maintenance, etc.) that are purchased and used.	RETAIN UNTIL: Fiscal year ends PLUS: 1 year THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026
24.523	Fixed Asset Inventory Data (obsolete)	This record is a list of all major property and its book value. City or village policy determines the value at which property must be included on an inventory. The value of these items is then distributed across the useful life of the property. Information on the inventory may include a description of the item, value, date purchased, depreciation amount, insurable value, building location, etc.	Superseded by GS #31.123	3/31/2026
24.524	Fixed Asset Annual Report (obsolete)	The Government Accounting Standards Board (GASB) Statement 34 establishes the annual reporting requirements for financial statements prepared by state and local governments. This annual report is produced from the fixed asset inventory.	Superseded by GS #31.124	3/31/2026

Item #	Record Series Title	Record Series Description	Retention Period	Approval Date
24.525	Audits - Final Report (obsolete)	Audit reports are prepared annually by independent accounting firms.	Superseded by GS #31.127	3/31/2026
24.526	Indirect Costs (obsolete)	These records are created annually to determine the allowable indirect cost rate that the city or village may charge to various state and federal grants.	Superseded by GS #31.129	3/31/2026
24.527	Surety Bonds	Officers and employees, especially those who handle money, may need a bond to protect the city or village against theft. These certificates identify the person who is bonded, the bonding company and the amount of the bond.	RETAIN UNTIL: No longer employed PLUS: 5 years THEN: Destroy	3/31/2026